

Green & Social Claims Risk Assessment

Methodology summary for website and internal-document scans

1. Purpose and scope

The tool provides an indicative first-pass assessment of green and social claims. It is designed to help identify wording that may be too broad, insufficiently substantiated, unsuitable for the communication channel, or potentially inconsistent with relevant external public-source signals. It is not a legal opinion, ESG rating or definitive finding of greenwashing or social washing.

2. Separate scan modes

Mode	What is assessed	What is not combined
Website scan	The entered URL plus a limited number of related company domains/pages where reachable. Public-source context may be used as an external signal layer.	Uploaded internal documents are not included.
Internal-document scan	One uploaded non-public document. The result focuses only on that document, its claims, evidence gaps and governance implications.	Website content and external public-source search are not included.

3. Regulatory and standards lenses

- **EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825:** used as the primary lens for consumer-facing environmental claims. Generic environmental claims, climate-neutrality or offsetting claims, sustainability labels, comparative claims and future environmental-performance claims are weighted more strongly when they appear in client-facing communication.
- **EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015:** used for social claims linked to products, suppliers, responsible sourcing, forced-labour-free or modern-slavery-free wording, traceability, import/export controls or withdrawal readiness.
- **OECD Guidelines, UN Guiding Principles, UN Global Compact, ILO and GRI:** used as broader responsible-business and disclosure references. These influence the analysis, but clear EmpCo or Forced Labour Regulation risk signals receive greater weighting.

4. Score model

Green and social scores are calculated separately. The global score is a conservative average of the two dimension scores and cannot exceed the highest dimension score. Sector exposure is included as a baseline sensitivity factor, but it cannot by itself create a High-risk result.

Driver	Weight	Interpretation
Claim wording	30%	Broad, generic, absolute or sensitive claim wording; product/supplier assurance; climate or forced-labour related wording.
Substantiation gap	30%	Missing scope, boundaries, methodology, KPIs, verification, limitations, grievance/remedy, traceability or corrective-action evidence.
External contradiction	25%	Retained external public-source signals only. Company-owned documents are excluded from this section.
Sector exposure	15%	Baseline sensitivity for sectors more prone to greenwashing or social-washing risks, such as food retail, apparel, energy, transport, finance and complex supply-chain sectors.

5. Communication-channel treatment

- **Client-facing websites and commercial documents** are assessed as claim communication. Environmental claims in this channel receive the strongest EmpCo relevance.
- **Investor and internal documents** such as annual reports, sustainability reports, ESG reports, policies and supplier codes are used mainly as evidence, governance and consistency sources. They still create risk if wording is absolute, unsupported or later reused in consumer-facing communication.
- **Uploaded internal documents** are assessed as a separate document-only scan. The tool does not merge them with website results.

6. External public-source signals

The external-source section is reserved for sources external to the company, such as regulators, courts, recognised media, NGOs, civil-society organisations, complaint bodies and public authorities. Company-owned websites, sustainability reports, annual reports, supplier codes, human-rights policies, modern-slavery statements and other company documents are excluded from the external-signal display. They may be used as evidence or consistency context, but not as external stakeholder signals.

7. Red flags

Red flags are split between green-claim red flags and social-claim red flags. Additional regulatory red flags are displayed when a detected claim potentially falls under the EmpCo environmental-claim lens or the EU Forced Labour Regulation product-market lens. A red flag is a prioritisation signal for review, not a legal finding.

8. Practical output

- A global risk score, green risk score and social risk score.
- Claim-level signals split between green claims and social claims.
- Company-specific score drivers, not only generic methodology text.
- Recommended actions focused on the detected claim types and evidence gaps.
- A two-page report designed for management, communications, legal and compliance review.

9. Limitations and disclaimer

This tool is an indicative first-pass assessment. It does not provide legal advice, does not establish a violation of EmpCo, the EU Forced Labour Regulation or any other legal framework, and does not make a definitive greenwashing or social-washing finding. Automated crawling may miss pages, blocked content, PDFs, paywalled material or non-HTML documents. External search results require manual verification. Results should be validated by legal, compliance and subject-matter experts before external use.